BOMB BUSTERS

2-5 | 30' | 14+

A game by Hisashi Hayashi, illustrated by Dom2D

COMPLETE GUIDE TO NOT EXPLODE

Game Components

1 board (with a dial)

Install the dial on the board before the first game



70 Wire tiles



48 blue wires
"1" to "12",
4 of each



11 red wires
"1.5" to "11.5"



11 yellow wires
"1.1" to "11.1"

17 cards



12 Equipment cards

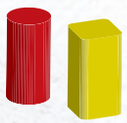


5 Character cards

5 tile stands



7 markers: 4 yellow and 3 red



40 tokens



26 Info tokens
(including 2 yellow ones)

12 Validation tokens



1 "=" token

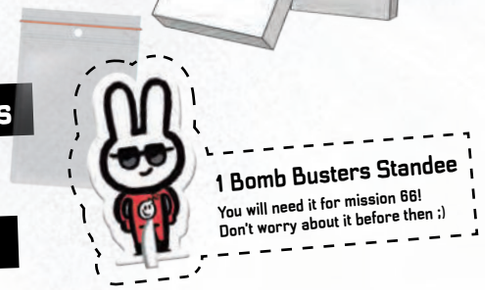
1 "≠" token

5 "Surprise" boxes

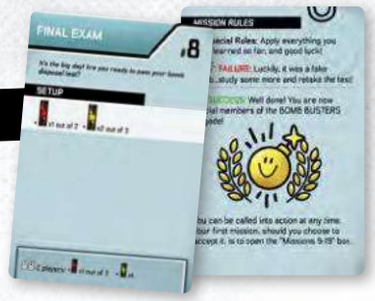
to open later



8 resealable bags



8 large Mission cards



1 set of rules

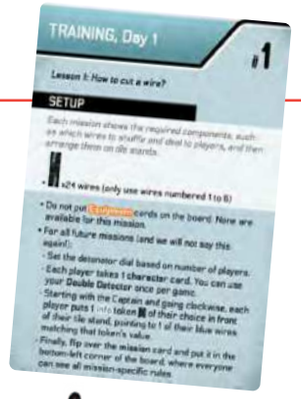
Aim of the Game

Bomb Busters is a cooperative game. Each player is a bomb disposal expert and all players together form one team. The objective is to defuse the assigned mission's bomb together. Beware! The bomb will explode if you cut a red wire or if the detonator dial reaches the end!

Setup

1. Select one of the Mission cards. The missions get progressively more difficult.
   You are not required to play the missions in order (but it is strongly recommended!).
   Just make sure you work through all of them so you fully learn how to play the game....





Training Missions

Novice (1-3): These missions teach you the basics.

Intermediate (4-7): These missions teach you some more advanced concepts.

Expert (8): This is the final exam to pass training. If you succeed, you can open the 9-19 Mission Box.



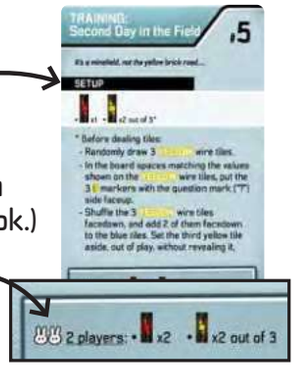
2. Designate a Captain (at random for the first mission, then pass the responsibility of Captain to the left before each subsequent mission). Place the "Captain" **character** card in front of this bomb disposal expert. Everyone else should place a **character** card of their choice faceup in front of them.

A new rule will soon appear here...
(A)

3. The Captain reads the Mission card aloud and places it, flipped over, to the bottom left of the board so everyone can see the special rules.

FRONT: The mission's setup instructions.

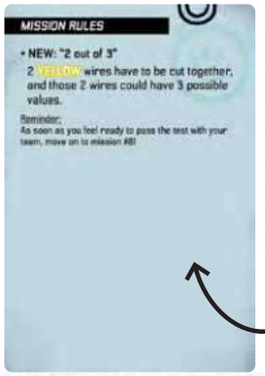
BACK: The mission's special rules. (Each mission may introduce new rules not found in this rulebook.)



Changes to Setup for 2 players

4. Depending on the number of bomb disposal experts, distribute tile stands as follows:

Players	Stands for Captain	Stands for Others
2	2	2
3	2	1
4	1	1
5	1	1



Back of the Mission card with special mission rules.

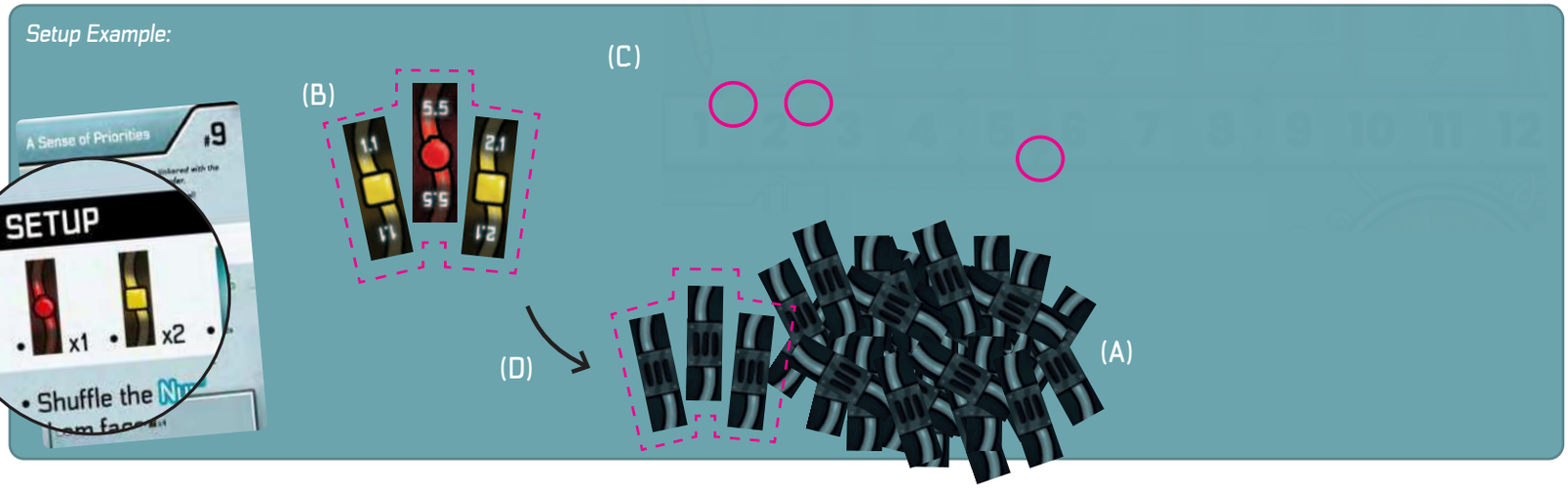
5 Prepare the mission's Wire tiles:

A. Collect all 48 blue wire tiles (except for training missions 1, 2 & 3). There are 4 copies of each number 1-12.

B. Take the number of red and yellow wires shown on the Mission card by drawing them at random.

C. Look at the red and yellow tiles drawn and indicate the red and yellow values by placing the appropriate red and/or yellow markers in the spaces on the board, with their blank side faceup (make sure the "?" symbol is facedown).

D. Then shuffle all the Wire tiles (blue + red + yellow) together facedown.

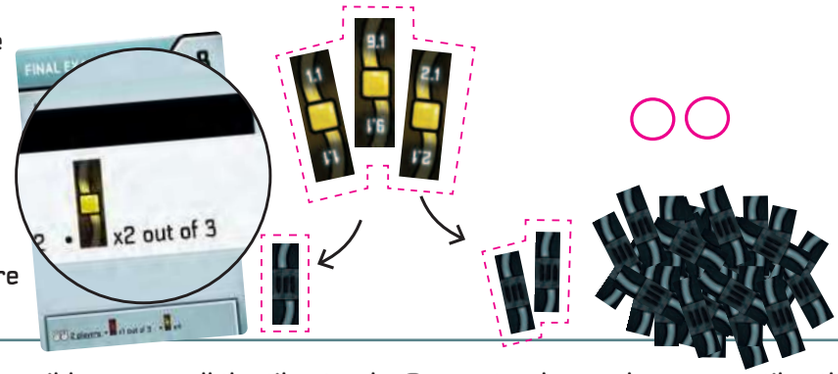


In some missions, the number of red and/or yellow wires is indicated as "1 out of 2", "1 out of 3", or "2 out of 3":

In this case, the wires involved are only partially known. For example, when setting up "2 out of 3 yellow wires":

1. Reveal 3 yellow Wire tiles.
2. Place 3 markers in matching board slots with their "?" side faceup to indicate that these numbers might be in play.
3. Shuffle the 3 tiles facedown, add 2 of them facedown to the pile of blue tiles, and set the third tile aside, out of play, without revealing it.

Thus, only 2 of the 3 yellow wires seen are actually in play, but all 3 possibilities are indicated by the "?" markers on the board.



6 Deal all wires facedown and as equally as possible among all the tile stands. Some stands may have more tiles than others.

7 Bomb disposal experts take their dealt wires and carefully place them in their tile stand. Tiles must be placed with **the information facing the bomb disposal expert** and sorted from left-to-right in ascending order. Tiles on a stand are in that bomb disposal expert's hand.

⚠ **NOTE:** When a bomb disposal expert has 2 tile stands, **deal, place, and sort the tiles separately for each stand**. Later, during the game, both tile stands together form the player's hand (for purposes of equipment, Info tokens, specific rules, etc.).

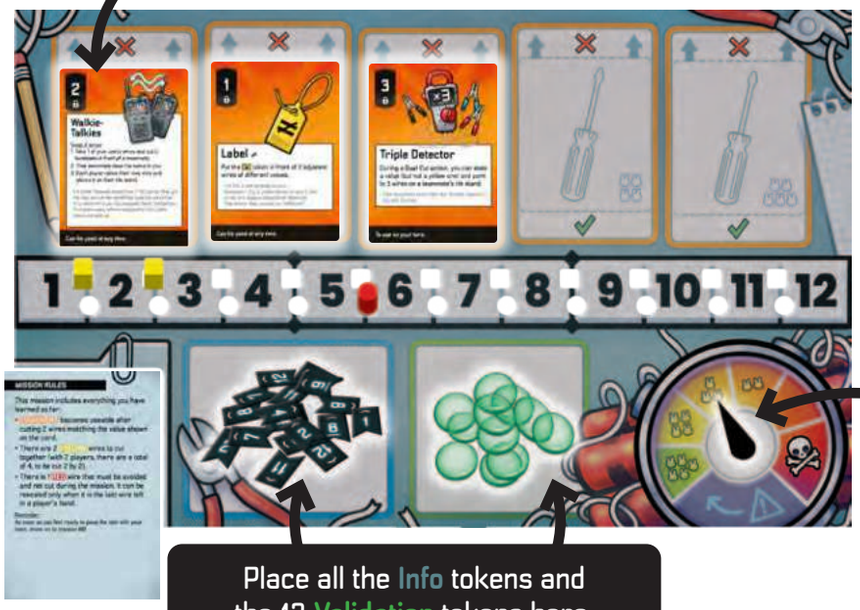


The decimal values shown on red and yellow wires are used only for sorting in ascending order. During the game they have no value, and are simply "RED" or "YELLOW".

8 On the board:

Take as many **Equipment** cards as there are bomb disposal experts and place them faceup over the checkmark ✔, as you cannot use them yet.
This is the only equipment available for this game.

Example setup for 3 bomb disposal experts



Set the detonator dial to the section matching the number of bomb disposal experts.

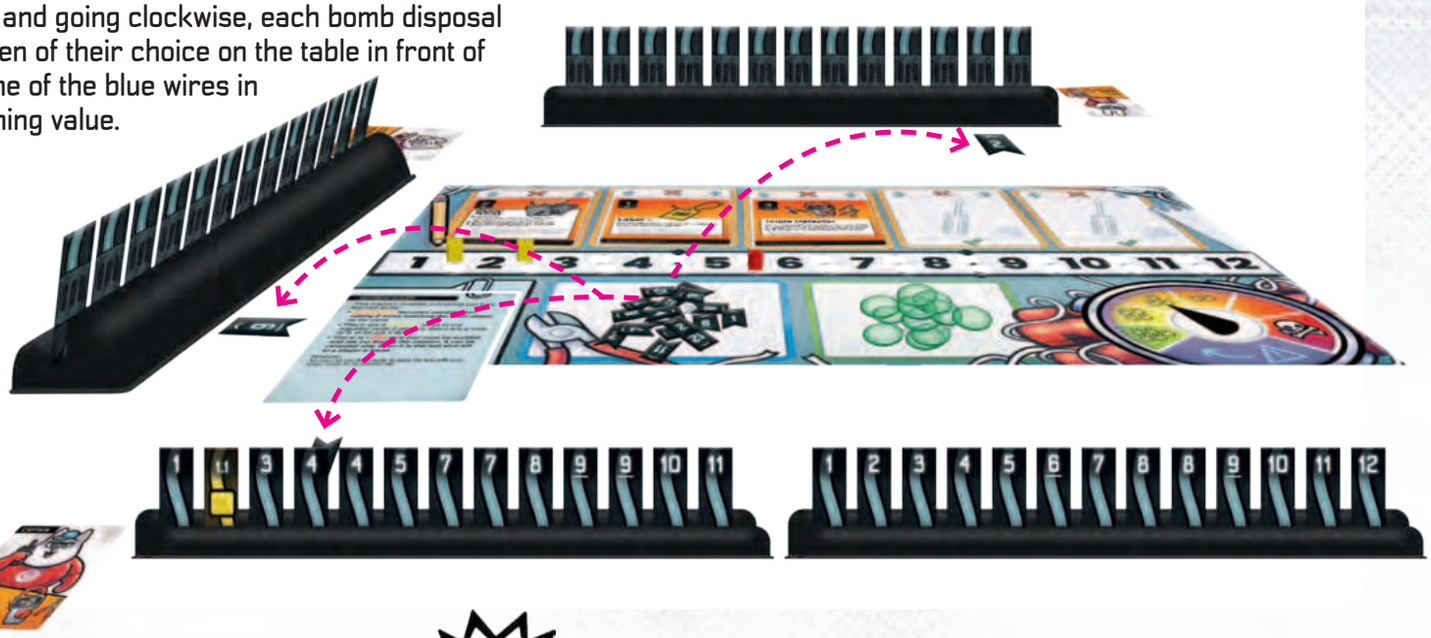
Place all the Info tokens and the 12 Validation tokens here.

A new rule will soon appear here...
(B)

A new rule will soon appear here...
(C)

9 Starting with the Captain and going clockwise, each bomb disposal expert places an Info token of their choice on the table in front of their stand, pointing to one of the blue wires in their hand with the matching value.

⚠ You cannot use the yellow during setup.



⚠ Remember:
2 tile stands = 1 hand. So be aware, when a bomb disposal expert has 2 tile stands, they only place 1 Info token (in front of the tile stand and blue wire of their choice).

The Game

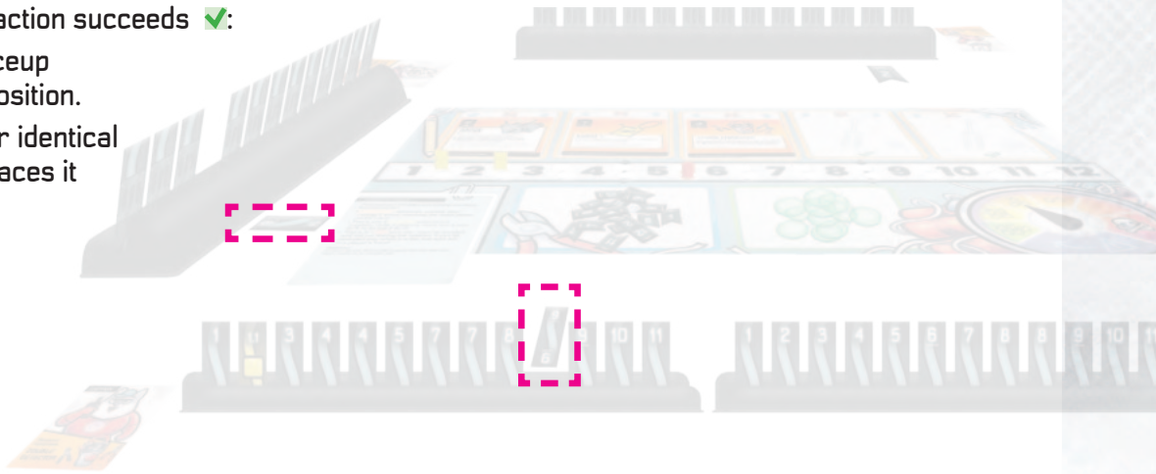
Starting with the Captain and going clockwise, each bomb disposal expert takes a turn. On their turn, a bomb disposal expert (called the "active bomb disposal expert") must do 1 of the following 3 actions: Dual Cut action, Solo Cut action, or Reveal Your Red Wires action.

Dual Cut Action

The active bomb disposal expert must cut 2 identical wires: 1 of their own and 1 of their teammates'. They clearly point to a specific teammate's wire and guess what it is, stating its value. For example *"This wire is a 9"*.

A If the active bomb disposal expert is correct, the action succeeds ✅:

- Their teammate takes that wire and places it faceup in front of their tile stand, without changing its position.
- Then the active bomb disposal expert takes their identical wire (or one of them if they have several) and places it faceup in front of their tile stand.



The Captain points to a teammate's "9," which just so happens to be a match. The dual cut action succeeds!

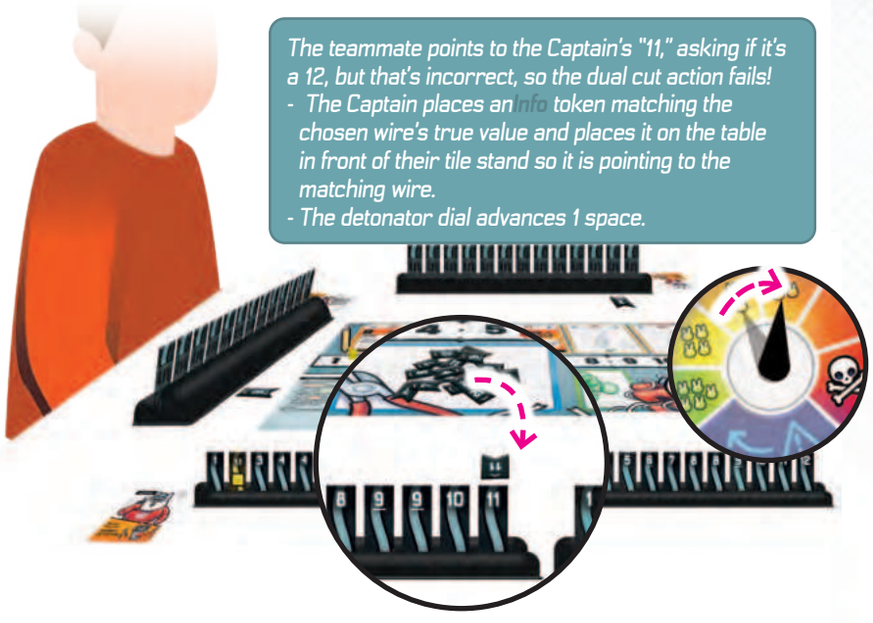
- *The teammate places the chosen "9" wire faceup in front of their tile stand.*
- *The Captain also reveals one of their "9s" and plaæs it faceup in front of their own tile stand.*

B But if they are wrong, the action fails ❌:

- If the wire in question is red, the bomb explodes, and the mission ends in failure;
- If the wire in question is blue or yellow, the detonator dial advances 1 space (the bomb explodes if the dial reaches the skull and the mission fails), and their teammate places an Info token in front of the wire in question to show its real value.

⚠ **Note:** The active bomb disposal expert does not show where in their own hand the tile they had wanted to cut is.





The teammate points to the Captain's "11," asking if it's a 12, but that's incorrect, so the dual cut action fails!

- *The Captain places an Info token matching the chosen wire's true value and places it on the table in front of their tile stand so it is pointing to the matching wire.*
- *The detonator dial advances 1 space.*

Solo Cut Action

If the last of identical wires still in the game appear only in the active bomb disposal expert's hand, then they can cut those identical wires in pairs (either 2 or 4). This can be done on their own, without involving another bomb disposal expert.

- If they are lucky enough to have a full set of 4, they can cut all 4 wires at once.
- If a pair of wires of a given value have already been cut, they can cut the remaining 2 matching wires in their hand.

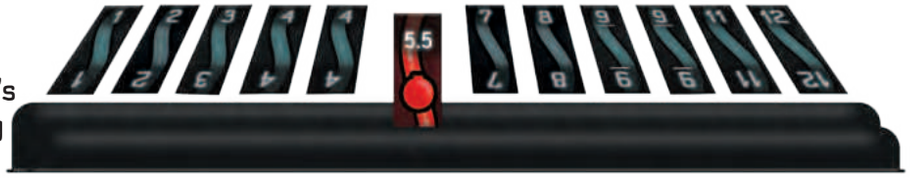
These cut wires are placed faceup on the table in front of the tile stand.

In this example, two "9s" were cut previously. The active bomb disposal expert carries out a Solo cut action: They cut the two remaining "9s" which are in their hand (in this case, on two tile stands).



Reveal Your Red Wires Action

This action can occur only if the active bomb disposal expert's remaining uncut wires are all RED. They reveal them, placing them faceup on the table in front of their tile stand.



VALIDATION TOKENS

As soon as all 4 wires of the same value have been cut, place 1 Validation token on the matching number on the board. This visual reminder can save time and maybe even your life!



THE YELLOW WIRES

Yellow wires are cut the same way as blue wires (**Dual** or **Solo Cut**), but the numeric value is used only when sorting the tiles on the stand in ascending order during setup. During the game, all yellow wires are considered to have the same value: "YELLOW".

To cut a yellow wire, the active bomb disposal expert must have one in their hand, point to a teammate's wire, and say "This wire is yellow." If they are correct, the 2 wires are cut. Otherwise if incorrect, just as with blue wires, an Info token that reveals the actual value of the identified wire is placed, and the detonator dial advances 1 space.

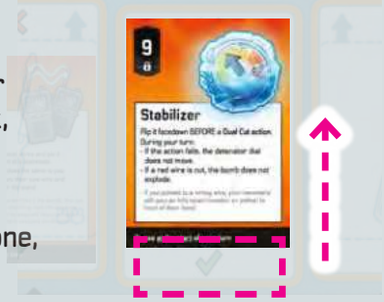
- If a yellow wire is pointed at incorrectly, a yellow Info token is used, and the detonator dial advances 1 space.
- A **Solo Cut** action using yellow wires can occur only with a bomb disposal expert who has **all the remaining yellow wires in their hand**.



THE EQUIPMENT CARDS

- A piece of equipment becomes useable as soon as 2 wires of the value shown in the top-left corner of the card have been cut. Slide the equipment card up in its space to reveal the green checkmark, indicating that this effect is now useable.
- All equipment can be used only once. To show that it has been used, flip it facedown.
- The text on each card describes when the equipment can be used. Most can be used at any time by anyone, even not during their turn. A bomb disposal expert can use several equipment cards in a row.

NOTE: *The X or Y ray equipment can be combined with the Double Detector, Triple Detector, or Super Detector (to indicate 2 values along with several wires!)*



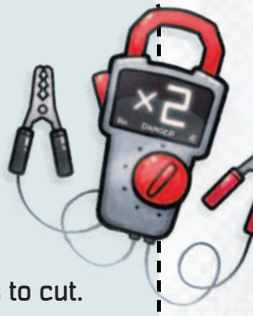
A pair of 9 wires is cut, equipment 9 becomes available.



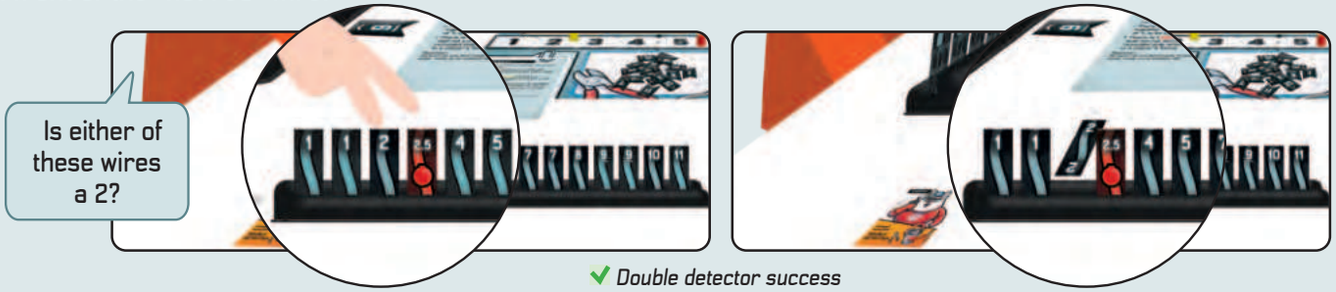
THE CHARACTER CARDS

Each bomb disposal expert can use the personal equipment on their character card **once per mission**. To show that it has been used, flip it facedown.

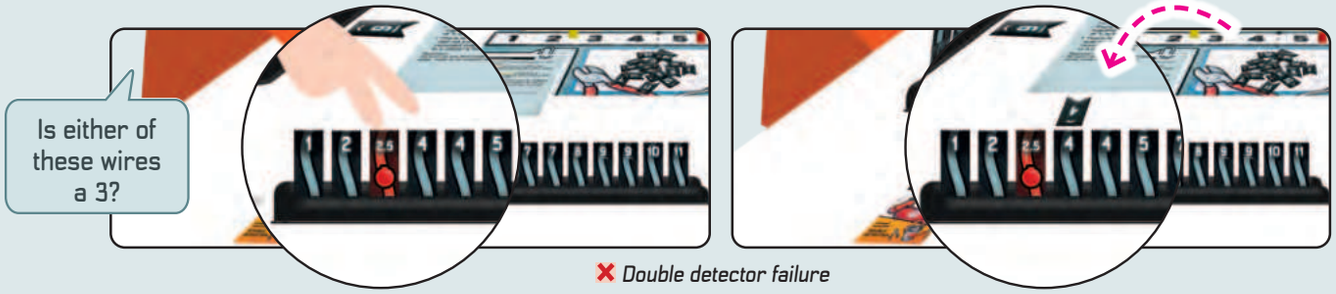
Double Detector: During a **Dual Cut action**, the active bomb disposal expert states a value and points to **2 wires** in a teammate's stand (instead of only 1).



- If either of these 2 wires matches the stated value, the action **succeeds**.
  - If **both wires** are named correctly, the teammate does not share any details and simply chooses which of the 2 chosen wires to cut.
- If neither of the 2 wires matches the stated value, the action **fails**.
  - The detonator dial advances 1 space, and the teammate places 1 Info token on the table in front of 1 of the 2 chosen wires (their choice).
  - If only 1 of the 2 chosen wires is red, the bomb does not explode. The teammate does not share any details and simply places an Info token in front of the "not red" wire.



✔ *Double detector success*



✖ *Double detector failure*



Clarifications

No More Wires: When a bomb disposal expert has no wires left in hand and their tile stand is empty, the mission just carries on without them. Simply skip this bomb disposal expert's turn and continue taking turns in clockwise order with the other bomb disposal experts who still have wires in their hands.

Communication: To facilitate the gameplay experience, communication is intentionally very limited.

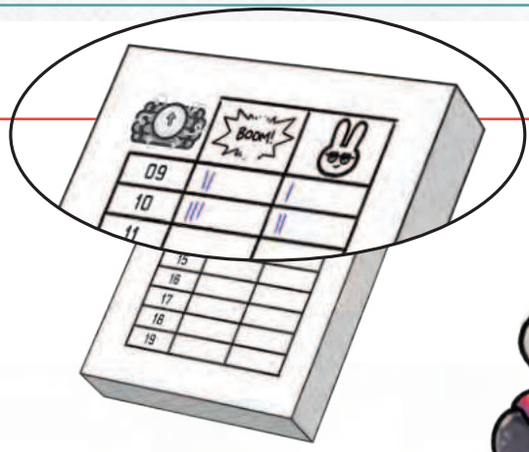
- **It is forbidden** to talk about the wires in one's hand, to imply their value, to recall information from previous turns, to share your guesses and assumptions aloud.
- **It is permitted** at any time to discuss general tactics, the use of equipment, to recall special rules, to remind a teammate to use their **Double Detector** or other equipment.

End of the Game

The mission ends in success when all bomb disposal experts have empty tile stands!

If the mission ends in failure (red wire cut or detonator dial advances to the ☠ space), change which player is the Captain and restart the mission!

After you complete mission 8—congratulations, you can now open the first "Surprise" box, (Missions 9-19). Feel free to use the table on the back of the box to track your progress.



Number of wins and losses



QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

Setup

→ Everyone takes 1 **character** card.
→ Shuffle the 48 blue wires with the red/yellow wires as indicated by mission setup instructions. Then distribute all wires facedown among tile stands as equally as possible.
→ With 2 bomb disposal experts, each bomb disposal expert will use 2 tile stands. With 3 bomb disposal experts, only the Captain uses 2 tile stands.
→ The number of equipment cards and the detonator dial's starting space will vary depending on the number of bomb disposal experts.
→ Each bomb disposal expert places 1 Info token in front of their stand (but not a yellow one during setup).



On Your Turn

→ On your turn, do 1 of these actions:

- **Dual Cut:**
  Choose a value on a tile in your hand, then point at a teammate's tile and ask them if that tile is the value you chose (hope for a match!).
  - ✅ **Matching values**: reveal both wires and place in front of their respective tile stands.
  - ❌ **Not matching values**: the detonator dial advances and, if it hasn't reached the ☠, an Info token of the teammate's chosen wire's true value is placed in front of it.
  - 💣 **Red wire**: the bomb explodes!
- **Solo Cut:**
  Reveal the 2 or 4 remaining wires of the same value and place them in front of your tile stand.
- **Reveal Your Red Wires:**
  If **all** your wires are red, reveal them.



End of the Game

→ Win: All the tile stands are empty!
→ Loss: The bomb exploded (red wire cut or detonator dial reached the ☠ space!)

REMEMBER:
- Each character has 1 personal equipment that can be used **once per game**.
- Equipment becomes useable **the first time 2 wires of the value shown on the card** have been cut.
- All the yellow wires are considered to have the same value: "yellow".
- All the red wires are considered to have the same value: "red".
- There are 4 copies of each blue wire from 1 to 12. **After all 4 wires of the same value have been cut**, place a Validation token on the board as a reminder.
- Double Stands: A bomb disposal expert with 2 tile stands treats them both as a single hand.
- On some mission cards you will find a QR code that leads to an audio file. If you are unable to scan QR codes, you can find the file at: www.pegasusna.com/bombbusters-en



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